



SERVICE EXCELLENCE TRAINING

Puff 'n Stuff Catering | Events

Service Training Manual

Service Training Manual

Puff 'n Stuff
EVENTS | CATERING

Passionately Perfecting Life's Celebrations

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Reading This Manual

The purpose of these modules are to emphasize the core policies and procedures of the SET program. This information will be used to provide the skills and training necessary to build the foundation of Service Excellence for all Puff n' Stuff Catering team members.

Throughout this manual you will find (4) different icons each symbolizing an important tidbit of information that will assist you while on the job.



TEAM WORK TIP → TIP

Teamwork is the “cooperative or coordinated effort on the part of a group of persons acting together as a team”. These tidbits will help you to function a single and effective unit.



EFFICIENCY TIP → TIP

Efficiency describes the extent to which time, effort or cost is well used for the intended task. These tidbits will help you to save time and ensure the accuracy.



SAFETY TIP → TIP

Maintaining proper food handling standards and staff safety are key elements on any event. These tidbits are reminders on important regulations and guidelines that will keep everyone smiling.



GLOSSARY WORD →

Important service and culinary based definitions. All service team members are expect to know every glossary word found within this manual.

Other approved Puff ‘n Stuff Catering training manuals available for continuing education include: Culinary, Lead Event Culinary, Supervisor and Bartender.

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Tables

Proper table set up and spacing lays a solid foundation for the organization of each event space.

Steps of Set Up: Round Wooden Guest Tables

1. Set table on its side with legs facing to the right.
2. Extend left table leg outward and away from the table.
3. Grasp the cross-handle portion between the legs and lock into place.
4. Repeat steps 2 and 3 to unlock the right leg.
5. With a partner, set the table up right into position.
6. Set table with legs positioned from 12 to 6.



Round wooden folding table

Chairs

Puff'n Stuff Catering owns and stores a large variety of chairs in-house in a vast range of shapes, sizes, and heights! Each chair has a specific purpose. For example, a padded folding chair would be ideal for an outdoor event, rather than a banquet chair.

Chairs should always be set symmetrically for even numbered guest counts and in the windows for odd numbered chairs. Never push or tuck chairs into the linen. The edge of the chair should just barely touch the linen!

Types of Chairs		
Banquet Chair	Padded Folding Chair	Chiavari Chair
		



SAFETY TIP→ CREATE AN ACCIDENT-FREE ENVIRONMENT

Make a diligent effort to keep all work environments safe and accident-free. Please observe safety rules at all times and report unsafe practices to your immediate Event Supervisor.

Steps of Set Up: Chairs (10 Top)

1. Set (1) guide chair at the 12 and 6 o'clock position.
2. Set (2) chairs between evenly spaced at the 3 o'clock position and (2) chairs evenly spaced at the 9 o'clock position.
3. Set remaining (6) chairs in the "windows."
4. (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (1) chair at 12 and the (2) chairs at 9.
5. (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (2) chairs at 9 and (1) chair at 6.
6. (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (1) chair at 6 and (2) chairs at 3.
7. (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (2) chairs at 3 and the (1) chair at 12.

Steps of Set Up: Chairs (7 Top)

1. Set (1) guide chair at the 12 o'clock position.
2. Set (2) chairs between evenly spaced at the 3 o'clock position and (2) chairs evenly spaced at the 9 o'clock position.
3. Set remaining (4) chairs in the "windows."
 - (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (1) chair at 12 and the (2) chairs at 9.
 - (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (2) chairs at 9 and (1) chair at 6.
 - (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (1) chair at 6 and (2) chairs at 3.
 - (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (2) chairs at 3 and the (1) chair at 12.



TEAM WORK TIP → CHAIR CHECK

Always check padded folding chairs for cleanliness as you are setting them. Once chairs are set in place, wipe chairs that are wet or dirty with a damp towel and pat dry. Any chair that is unstable, wobbly, or broken in anyway should be removed from the set up immediately. Tag the chair (with red tape) as broken and replace it with a new chair. Separate broken chairs from the good ones.

Steps of Set Up: Chairs (9 Top)

1. Set (1) guide chair at the 12 o'clock position.
2. Set (2) chairs evenly spaced at the 6 o'clock position
3. Set (1) chair at the 3 o'clock position and (1) chair at the 6 o'clock position.
4. Set remaining (6) chairs in the "windows."
5. (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (1) chair at 12 and the (1) chairs at 3 o'clock.
6. (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (1) chairs at 9 and (1) chair at 9 o'clock.
7. (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (1) chair at 3 and (2) chairs at 6 o'clock.
8. (1) Chair evenly spaced in between the (1) chairs at 9 and the (2) chairs at 6 o'clock.



EFFICIENCY TIP → COMPARE AND CONTRACT

Always compare the floor plan to the rentals section of the Special Event Order to determine the actual number of chairs per table before you set. Some tables may differ.

Chair Spacing and Guest Tables

1. Refer to the above steps to carry, set, and unlock the 60" or 72" round folding table.
2. Set table in upright position with table legs faced in the same direction with legs positioned from 12 to 6, creating symmetry throughout the room.
3. Leave approximately 5 feet between each table that is set, both to the front and back, and right and left.

Linens and Napkins

Puff 'n Stuff Catering owns, stores and cleans over 10,000 pieces of linen in a vast range of colors, sizes, fabrics and textures. Each perfectly selected tablecloth, overlay, accent linen, napkin, and sash has the ability to transform any event into a spectacular experience that our clients and their guests will remember.



Linen wall inside of Orlando commissary

Size and Shapes

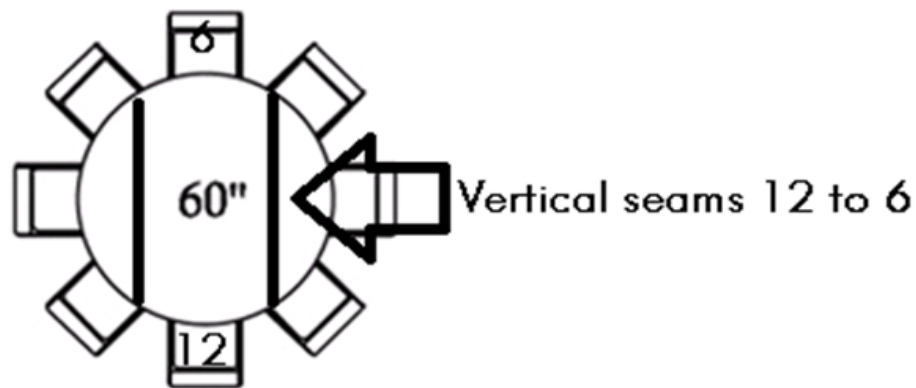
After cleaning, PnS linens are stored on hangers and categorized by size. Each hanger is labeled with a bright white linen tag that clearly displays the linen size and shape. Extra linen is typically sent to each event, as back up or emergencies, **but** always ask your Event Supervisor when attempting to use a different sized linen for a table other than what has been requested on the SEO. Each linen ordered and sent to the event has been designated to serve a purpose.



Linen tag

How to Set Linen (Guest Tables)

1. Refer to your Event Supervisor or the rentals section of the SEO for linen sizes, colors, and quantities ordered of each piece.
2. Remove the folded linen from the hangers piece by piece. Collect the empty hangers and bundle together in groups of 10-20. Tie together with plastic wrap and return to the breakdown area or event vehicle. **DO NOT THROW THE HANGERS AWAY.**
3. Place the folded linen on all of the tables before draping it. Do not throw or toss the linen onto the tables.
4. Set linens with parallel seams vertical to the way guests enter the room. Remember that the 12 o'clock position will always be the center chair from where the guest enters the room.
5. Vertical and horizontal creases of the linen should cross directly in the center of the table.
6. The length of the linen should be even on all sides in distance from the lip of the table to the floor. **NO** table legs should be visible.
7. Check linen for visible stains, loose threads, or tears in the fabric once it has been set on the table. Inform your Event Supervisor about the damaged linen.
8. Check linen for visible wrinkles. Replace the linen with another one in better condition, if available.





TEAM WORK TIP → LINEN BAGS AND TAGS

The warehouse supplies linen bags on each event. This assists our linen team to quickly sort and process all of the linen when it returns to the warehouse after your event!

How to Strike Linen

1. Collect any large debris, trash and remaining service items from the table before removing the linen.
2. Shake all linen free of food and debris into a garbage can after striking it from the table. Do not let the debris fall on the ground.
3. Alert your Event Supervisor if the linen has been stained or damaged during the event. Keep your eyes out for damage like red wine stains, candle wax, or burn holes as you clear the linen off the tables.
4. Bag dirty linen in linen bags. Approximately (8) pieces of linen fit into (1) medium-size linen bag.
5. If you don't have enough linen bags to hold all of the dirty linen, bundle the excess together. Spread (1) linen out like a blanket and then place remaining linens in the center. Tie all corners of the "blanket" linen together to create a bundle.
6. Never mix wet linen with dry linen. Separate any wet linen into a different bag. Do not tie the bag but instead, leave it open to allow the linen to dry.
7. Never mix dirty bar towels or kitchen rags in with dirty linen. Kitchen towels and/or rags should be stored in a separate kitchen container and organized on a dirty kitchen speed rack.



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Linen Napkins

Puff ‘n Stuff Catering has (3) standard napkin folds: tent fold, tri-fold, and menu-card fold. Napkins with tears, wrinkles, or stains should be separated and not used for service. Your SET trainer or Event Supervisor will demonstrate each of the folds for you.

SET UP-WORK STATION

Retrieve all required equipment for set up with your set up partners.

Determine the available work space. If you are unable to create a work station at one of the guest seating tables, set up (1) 6 or 8 foot table in close proximity to the guest seating tables as your work station. Be careful to keep aisle ways clear so that your team and other vendors working in the space have clear access to and from the back of house.

Set your napkin bin up on the work table. If you are working from one of the guest seating tables, do not place the linen bin on the table or on the guest chairs.

Count your napkins. Each stack of napkins is wrapped and labeled in packs of (25).

If you are missing any inventory, check your surrounding set up areas, all carts, and the event vehicle. If it cannot be located anywhere on-site, alert your Event Supervisor immediately.

SET UP-NAPKINS

1. Refer to the sample setting to identify what napkin fold you will be folding.
2. Complete the following double check list before placing your napkins at each place setting:
 - Is the linen is properly placed on the table with vertical seams running from 12 to 6 in relationship to the guest entrance?
 - Is the chair count at each table correct according to the SEO and/or floor plan?
 - Is there a guide chair placed at the 12 o'clock position?
 - Are the remaining chairs (if they are already set) in proper position and evenly spaced around the table?
 - Are the place settings evenly spaced and properly aligned with the chair?

If you answered no to any of the above questions, correct the issue with your fellow set up team members before continuing on with set up.

3. Throw the plastic wrap from the napkins away in the trash can at your work station. It will not be re-used for storage or bussing.

4. Set the first napkin at the 12 o'clock position. Work clock-wise around the table.
5. Stand directly behind the chair in order to place the napkin directly in the center of the place setting.
6. Always set the napkin one inch from the edge of the table. The space between your knuckle placed at the base of the table and the tip of your thumb measures approximately 1 inch. The bottom of the napkin should line up precisely with the bottom of the flatware.
7. Complete an entire table before moving on to set the next.
8. Once you have completed your assigned task, request your next job from your Event Supervisor before doing anything else.

EFFICIENCY TIP→ STACK AND SET!

Always stack linen napkins as you fold them and sort into groups based on the table chair counts. For 10 tables with 10 chairs each, fold and sort napkins in 10 stacks of 10! Fold and sort all linen napkins into stacks first, then set the stack of napkins at each table, and finally place the napkins into proper position at each individual place setting.



Menu Fold



Tent Fold



Tri Fold



Standard Table Settings

*The type of table setting varies from event to event based on the menu and the service style. Some events that are cocktail style or provide limited seating may not even require place settings! Always refer to your **sample setting** for the event specific flatware and glassware needed.*

Each team member will be assigned a piece of flatware to complete the place settings. When you have placed your last piece of flatware on the tables, work with your other set up partners to complete the room before moving on to a new task.



GLOSSARY TERM → SAMPLE SETTING

A sample setting is a full table setting that serves as a reference tool for the service team to work from. Each fork, knife, serving utensil, and salt and pepper shaker has a specific place on the table for a reason. Never deviate away from how the sample setting has been done without permission from your Event Supervisor. A diagram or handout may also be given to you with the required items and correct placement of items on the table.



Building A Polishing Work Station

- A. Polishing cloths or linen napkins
- B. Pitcher(s) filled with hot water
- C. (1) 6 or 8 Foot Table
- D. (1) Slim jim trash can
- E. (2) Trash bags
- F. Box of Latex Gloves (Available in SM/MED/LG/XL.)

Flatware Equipment



Complete "Shell" patterned flatware set

- | | |
|-----------------|--------------------|
| A. Teaspoon | F. Steak knife |
| B. Soup Spoon | G. Demitasse Spoon |
| C. Salad Fork | H. Cocktail Fork |
| D. Dinner Fork | I. B&B Knife |
| E. Dinner Knife | |

Coffee Cups and Glassware Equipment



- | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|------------------------------------|---|---|
| G | A | B | C | D | E | F |
| | H | | | | | |
| | A. Rocks Glass (juice) | | | D. Red Wine Glass | | |
| | B. European (Euro) Beverage Glass (Water, Soda, Iced Tea) | | | E. Champagne Flute | | |
| | C. White Wine Glass | | | F. Irish Coffee Mug (Station Only) | | |

Setting Up A Work Station

1. Retrieve all required equipment for set up with your team members. Refer to the sample setting to identify what pieces of flatware are needed for the place settings.
2. Set up (1) 6 or 8 foot table in close proximity to the guest seating tables as your work station. Be careful to keep aisle ways clear so that your team and other vendors working in the space have clear access to and from the back of house.
3. Set your flatware bins up on the work table along with the linen napkins or polishing cloths, pitcher(s) of hot water, and double-bagged trash can.
4. Count your flatware before you begin any set up. Each bag of flatware contains (25) pieces.
5. If you are missing any inventory, check your surrounding set up areas, all carts, and the event vehicle. If it cannot be located anywhere on-site, alert your Event Supervisor immediately.
6. Once you have completed your assigned task(s), clean up your work area and return any empty plate crates or bins to the breakdown station.
7. Request your next job from your Event Supervisor before doing anything else.

Place Setting Is As Easy as 1, 2, 3....

1. Flatware
2. Coffee/Saucers
3. Glassware



EFFICIENCY TIP→ POLISH AS YOU GO!

With a pitcher of hot water and a polishing cloth or linen napkin, spot polish flatware and glassware as you set. **Always wear gloves while setting flatware or glassware!** Wearing gloves while handling flatware or glassware will ensure that all of the service ware remains spotless and free of smudges!

Step1: Set Up Flatware

1. Refer to your Event Supervisor for the correct guest count and number of chairs per table.
2. Complete the following check list before beginning set up:
 - ⇒ Are the guest seating tables evenly spaced?
 - ⇒ Is the linen properly placed on the table with vertical seams running from 12 to 6 in relationship to the guest entrance?
 - ⇒ Is the chair count at each table correct according to the SEO and/or floor plan?
 - ⇒ Is there a guide chair placed at the 12 o'clock position?
 - ⇒ Are the remaining chairs (if set yet) in proper position and evenly spaced around the table?

*If you answer **no** to any of the above questions, correct the issue with your fellow team members before continuing on with set up.*
3. Open the bag of flatware from the bottom side and hold only the handle, not the knife blade or the fork tines. Remove enough pieces of flatware from the bag to set an entire table before starting.
4. Set the first place setting at the 12 o'clock position. Work clock-wise around the table. Complete an entire table before moving on to set the next.
5. Stand directly behind the chair in order to place the outer pieces of the flatware with the outside posts of the chair. The place setting should measure approximately 12 inches from the outer pieces inward.
6. Always set flatware one inch from the edge of the table. The space between your knuckle and the tip of your thumb measures approximately one inch.



TEAM WORK TIP → SWEEP THE ROOM

Always set the room sweeping from the wall closest to the public entrance and work your way as a team toward the back of house. This ensures that the tables closest to the guest entrance will be set and ready in the event that the doors are opened early or before our team has completed the set up.

Step 2: Set Up Coffee Cups and Saucers

1. Set pre-set coffee cups and saucers directly to the right of the knife.
2. Set coffee cup handles in the 4 o'clock position.
3. Set teaspoon for coffee service at the top of place setting with the handle facing toward the knives.
4. Sugar caddies and creamers may be pre-set on the tables or offered tableside depending on service.
5. Complete an entire table before moving on to set the next.



Step 3: Set Up Glassware

1. All flatware must be set in position on the tables before glassware may be set!
2. When possible, use a glass rack dolly to roll the glassware from table to table as you set. When a dolly is not available, carry a tray jack with you as you set, moving from section to section. As you finish an empty rack, remove it from the floor or place neatly in a stack with others on the perimeter of the room, not in an aisle way.
3. As you set the table, handle all glassware by the stem, not the bulb of the glass.
4. Set the first piece of glassware at the chair in the 12 o'clock position. Work clockwise around the table. Complete an entire table before moving on to set the next.
5. Stand directly behind the chair in order to place the outer pieces of the glassware with the outside posts of the chair.
6. When all glasses have been placed on the tables, complete a perimeter sweep of the room to pick up all remaining empty glass racks. Return them to the staging area and stack neatly and organize by type of glass rack at the breakdown station.



GLOSSARY TERM → 12 O'CLOCK POSITION

The 12 o'clock position is considered the first position at the table. It will always be the center chair from where the guest enters the room. With each table's guide chair set at the 12 o'clock position, you will be able to evenly space the remaining place settings with precision!

Standard Place Setting Templates

Single place setting, (1) glass, tri-fold napkin



- A. Dinner fork
- B. Tri-fold napkin
- C. Dinner knife
- D. B&B knife
- E. B&B plate
- F. European beverage glass (Water, Iced Tea)

Double place setting, (3) glasses, tri-fold napkin



- A. Salad fork(s)
- B. Dinner fork
- C. Tri-fold napkin
- D. Dinner knife
- E. Steak knife
- F. B&B knife
- G. B&B plate
- H. Teaspoon
- I. European beverage glass (Water, Iced Tea)
- J. Ceramic coffee cup
- K. Ceramic coffee saucer

Standard Place Setting Templates

Double place setting, (2) glasses, tri-fold napkin



- A. Salad fork(s)
- B. Dinner fork
- C. Tri-fold napkin
- D. Dinner knife
- E. Steak knife
- F. B&B knife
- G. B&B plate
- H. Teaspoons
- I. European beverage glass (Water, Iced Tea)
- J. Champagne flute
- K. Ceramic coffee cup
- L. Ceramic coffee saucer

Double place setting, (3) glasses, tri-fold napkin



- A. Salad fork(s)
- B. Dinner fork
- C. Tri-fold napkin
- D. Dinner knife
- E. Steak knife
- F. B&B knife
- G. B&B plate
- H. Teaspoons
- I. European beverage glass (Water, Iced Tea)
- J. Champagne flute
- K. White wine or all-purpose wine glass (Placed at 5 o'clock of the Euro glass)
- L. Ceramic coffee cup
- M. Ceramic coffee saucer

Standard Place Setting Templates

Double place setting, (2) glasses, tri-fold napkin



- A. Salad fork(s)
- B. Dinner fork
- C. Tri-fold napkin
- D. Dinner knife
- E. Steak knife
- F. B&B knife
- G. B&B plate
- H. Teaspoons
- I. European beverage glass (Water, Iced Tea)
- J.



EFFICIENCY TIP → MATCH IT UP

Always check to make sure all of the equipment you are setting is of the same size, shape, and style before setting it on the guest seating tables. If there are any discrepancies, alert your Event Supervisor for further instruction.

Standard Table Pre - Set Item

Each event is different and as a result, some of the items listed above may or may not be necessary for service. Salt and pepper shakers and lemon wedges will always be set on any table with place settings. Always check with your Event Supervisor for the list of which items you will need to pre-set!





Set Up - Work Station

1. Refer to your Event Supervisor for the correct guest count and number of seating tables.
2. Retrieve all required equipment for set up. Refer to the sample setting to identify what items will be set on the tables and in what position.
3. Set up (1) 6 or 8 foot table in the staging area as your work station. Be careful to keep aisle ways clear so that your team and other vendors working in the space have clear access to and from the back of house.
4. Set your items up on the work table along with a double-bagged trash can.
5. Count your items before you begin any set up.



SAFETY TIP → COLD FOOD COLD

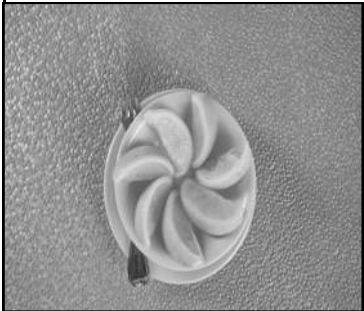
Set any perishable items, including salad dressing, butter, and cream last and no more than approximately 15-30 minutes prior to service and/or doors open. .

Pre-Set Items

Pre-set all under liner plates before setting the item(s) on the guest seating tables.

Equipment Needed - Pre-Set Items Per Table

- A. (1) Salt and pepper shaker set
 - B. (8) Lemon wedges in monkey dish on 5" plate with cocktail fork
 - C. (1) Butter on 5" plate
 - D. (1) Creamer on 5" plate
 - E. (2) Goosenecks on 7" plate with teaspoons
 - F. (1) Sugar caddy
- *Note: This is 1/3 regular sugar, 1/3 Splenda, 1/3 Sweet and Low
- A. (1) Set of tongs for bread basket
 - B. 5" Under liner plates for lemons, butter, creamer
 - C. 7" Under liner plates for goosenecks

Pre-Set Items		
LEMON WEDGES 	SALT + PEPPER 	CREAMER 
SUGAR CADDIES 	GOOSENECKS 	BREAD BASKETS 
BUTTER + PINK SEA SALT 		E.V.O.O. + BALSAMIC 

Tray Handling

The first rule to remember is to load the heaviest items in the middle of the tray, and put the lighter (well, less heavy) items closer to the edge of the tray. May sound like a no-brainer, but when servers are busy and feeling rushed they may end up not following this rule; results may be disastrous.

Ironically, it is easier to carry a tray with one hand underneath. It seems intuitive that using both hands would be more stable, but in reality, one hand is best. You may already know this if you have carried bar trays full of drinks. The counter-intuitive physics remain the same when the tray gets wider and heavier.



How To Carry A Football Tray

1. Place your palm under the center, with your wrist facing out, and push over your shoulder. Never carry the tray at waist level or in front of you.

2. Use your free hand to steady the tray, open doors, and close doors.
3. Approach the tray jack from the open side or it will close up on you when you put your tray down.
4. Take a knee, and lower yourself down till your shoulder and the tray jack are in line. Put the edge of the tray on the tray jack, and steady with your free hand.
5. Grab the post of the tray jack and slide the tray fully onto the jack.



SAFETY TIP → SLIPPERY WHEN WET!

Never attempt to carry any tray that has a wet or greasy bottom! This will prevent you from grasping a firm grip on the tray and increase the chance of an accident.

SAFETY TIP → OVERLOADING

Never load more than you can carry. Two trips are better than one that causes a spill!

How To Set And Use Tray Jacks

1. Set tray jacks around the perimeter of the room only.
2. Set tray jacks with tray jack covers. Wrap tray jacks in black linen if covers are not available. Metal tray jacks should never be set in the room without a cover.
3. Set (1) large oval tray on the tray jack for bussing. Line each tray with (2) black linen napkins.
4. Replace the linen napkins on your large oval trays throughout service as they become soiled or dirty.

Plated Service

1. Set tray jacks in groupings of (3).
2. Use (1) tray jack for water pitchers, wine, and additional clean service ware.
3. Use (2) tray jacks dedicated solely for serving and clearing.

Cocktail Trays

Line all cocktail trays with a black linen napkin. Never use a bare tray to serve or clear front of house.



EFFICIENCY TIPS → The 5x5 RULE

Stack scraped plates no more than 5 high and in no more than 2 stacks side by side per tray.

CLEAN WITH CLEAN, DIRTY WITH DIRTY!

Keep beverages (wine and champagne bottles, water pitchers, etc.) on a separate tray. Do not bus dirty plates or glassware on this tray. Clean with clean, dirty with dirty!

How To Bus To A Football Tray

1. Set (1) jack and (1) bussing tray for dirty china plates, flatware, and service ware.
2. Set (1) jack and (1) bussing tray for dirty glassware.
3. Bus quietly and refrain from banging or slamming plates on the tray.
4. Place fragile, tall or top heavy stemware like champagne flutes in the center of the tray to create a barrier. These items can fall off easily when you are carrying the tray around a corner items near the middle of the tray, slightly closer to one of the long sides. Pick the tray up from the side that the plates are closer to.
5. Clear only (2) plates at a time by hand to your side stand or use a small cocktail tray to bus items from the table.
6. Place (2) plates side by side and slide food debris onto one plate and stack the others. Do this with your back to the guests at your tray.
7. Separate all dirty flatware by type. Place salad forks in a separate area on your tray from salad knives, and bread and butter knives in a different stack than steak knives.
8. Separate all glassware by type. Create even rows of like glassware to distribute weight evenly across the tray. Lay empty bottles down to prevent them from falling off the tray.



TIP → THE TRAY

Never place the tray on a chair or on a guest seating table as you bus. Your bussing tray should always remain on top of your side stand unless you are carrying it to, or off the floor. **Never lean your tray against the wall.**

Breakdown Stations

A successful breakdown begins at the very start of the event. A well planned back of the house space helps set the tone for an organized service.

The size of the breakdown station you build will vary from event to event. Think strategically about the back of house space you are using! Back of house is always considered front of house and all work areas should be in show ready shape at all times. Always strive to leave the event site just as clean, if not cleaner, then you found it.

Your Event Supervisor and Lead Event Chef will determine the location for the staging area and breakdown station during the initial venue walk through. Breakdown station locations are used for bussing and may range from a client's garage to a small narrow hallway or even in the back of a Puff 'n Stuff Catering vehicle!



Set sample flatware in front of & in each bus tub.

Equipment Needed:

- A. 6 or 8 Foot tables
- B. Trash cans
- C. Bus tubs
- D. Plate crates
- E. Glass racks
- F. Dump buckets/Strainers for dump buckets
- G. Linen bags
- H. Tray jacks
- I. Sanitation wipes

How To Set Up A Breakdown Station

1. Set breakdown station up in the order in which you bus: trash cans, flatware, service ware, plates, dump bucket, and glassware.
2. Line all trash cans at breakdown station with (2) trash bags. Set (1) trash bag in trash can. Place second trash bag inside the first. Tie corner of BOTH bags together so that the inside trash bag does not fall inside the first.
3. If space allows, stage tray jacks at either end of the breakdown station to allow you and your teammates to bus trays easily to the station.
4. Set bus tubs for each type of flatware and serviceware (ex: tongs, goosenecks) used during service. All flatware must be separated by type and cannot be mixed together.
5. Set a sample piece of each type of flatware in **AND** in front of each bus tub for reference. ****Sheet pans or other similar vessels may be used in place of bus tubs if not enough are available.***
6. Set a sample plate in each plate crate for reference. All plates must be separated by type and cannot be mixed together.
7. Stage linen bags at either end of the breakdown station to collect linen napkins.
10. Set dump bucket with strainer on top immediately below/before the glass racks.

Trash, Liquid and Ice Disposal

1. Determine if trash can be disposed of in an on-site dumpster or must be packed on the event vehicle and discarded at the Puff 'n Stuff commissary.
2. Dispose of the dump bucket strainer debris (stir sticks, bar fruit, napkins, and bar picks) in a trash can only.
3. Only dump ice or liquid into working sinks, drains, or dump buckets. Never dump ice into the grass. If you are unsure if you are able to properly dispose of trash or liquid on-site, always ask your Event Supervisor!

GLOSSARY TERM → DUMP BUCKET



A dump bucket is an empty container used to pour the remaining liquid from glasses used during service. Each dump bucket is covered with a strainer to catch debris like stir sticks, bar fruit, napkins, and bar picks from falling into the liquid. Never pour liquid into the garbage cans. Conversely, do not clear trash or debris into the dump buckets!



Décor

1. Return all décor items to the container(s) it was sent in. Never load décor in a container with other event equipment.
2. Pack all fragile décor in bubble wrap.

Venue Clean Up

Comply with all items on facility caterer agreement checklist for end of event to include:

- Strike and/or reset of tables and chairs
- Sweeping, vacuuming, and mopping of facility floors and carpets
- Removal of all trash from the property
- Cleaning of kitchen space and equipment
- Wipe down all counters, food prep, and breakdown areas
- Remove all food debris from ovens, stove tops, and hot boxes
- Remove all food and beverage product from on-site refrigerators or walk-in coolers
- Clear all sink drains of debris and ice

Coffee & Cold Beverage Stations

A beverage station is one of the most frequented areas at any event, and is often the first place that guests are drawn to when they arrive. Sometimes before even putting their purses, jackets or sweaters down, they'll grab a quick drink! Having an organized and well stocked area set up ahead of time will insure that the event runs smoothly.

Puff 'n Stuff Catering offers several coffee and hot tea options for our clients to add to their event. From a traditional coffee station with regular and decaf coffee to a gourmet station that offers a variety of decadent accompaniments for guests to add to their coffee creations!



GLOSSARY TERM → COFFEE URN

A coffee urn is a large metal vessel capable of holding hot liquid at a hot temperature for extended periods of time. Sterno fuel canisters heat the urns and last for approximately (6) hours.



Building A Coffee/Tea Station

Equipment Needed:: Tables and Linen

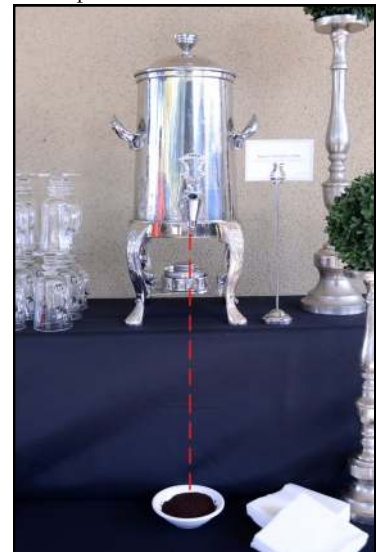
- A. (1) 6 or 8 Foot Table
- B. (1) 6 or 8 Foot Bar Top
- C. (2) 6 or 8 Foot Linens

Equipment Needed:: Product

- A. Regular coffee
- B. Decaf coffee
- C. Half and half
- D. Irish coffee mugs
- E. (2) 50 Cup coffee urns
- F. (2) Sterno
- G. (3) Sugar caddies
- H. Regular sugar, Splenda, Sweet 'n Low
- I. Creamer vessels
- J. Teaspoons on under liner (Use stir sticks if the event is disposable)
- K. (2) Monkey dishes for coffee grounds
- L. (1) Container coffee grounds
- M. (1) White porcelain bowl or basket for station garbage
- N. (1) Box white square beverage napkins
- O. (2) Menu card labels for coffee:(2) Menu card holders
- P. (2) Sets of (3) votive candles
- Q. Décor as specified by your Event Supervisor



50 Cup Coffee Urn



*For disposable events, use insulated PnS logo coffee cups with lids. Double the quantity of coffee cups set on station. Substitute platter of teaspoons for stir sticks. Display in coffee cup. Include (1) trash can with cover at station.

*For hot tea, include (1) additional 50 cup coffee urn for hot water, (1) wooden tea box, and honey, candied orange rind, and lemon wedges. Refer to SEO for specific accompaniments.

Station Set Up

1. Set base of coffee urns on bar top table. Set coffee urn on top of base. Adjust urns so that the levers are set toward the guest.
2. Set rows of Irish coffee mugs in center of bar top table between both coffee urns.
3. Set all mugs with handles angled to the right.
4. Check to ensure that all glasses are clean and free of debris or water spots. Do not use any glasses that are not clean or foggy. Polish with hot water and a linen napkin as needed.
5. Fill the (3) sugar caddies. Set all sugar packet labels with labels facing forward in the same direction.
6. Set (2) white porcelain bowls or baskets for used teaspoons and trash
7. Set (2) cleanly stacked sets of white square beverage napkins on either side of table.
8. Fill (2) monkey dishes with coffee grinds. Place on table directly underneath the coffee urns. This is to catch the drip from the coffee urns
9. Set (1) menu card holder with label to the side of each coffee urn on bar top table. Set regular coffee label on right and decaf coffee on left.
10. Set trio of votive candles on either side of the station. Check with your Event Supervisor for any additional station décor.
11. Fill coffee urns approximately (30) minutes before service begins. Light Sterno (30) minutes before service begins.
12. Fill and set creamers with half and half on station approximately 15 minutes before service begins.
13. Light votive candles 15 minutes before service begins.





5 Gallon Cambro



10 Gallon Cambro

Station Replenish

1. Check coffee station periodically to replenish coffee, creamer, teaspoons, mugs, and remove trash.
2. Replenish Irish coffee mugs and teaspoons as needed. Bring clean mugs to the station on a linen-lined cocktail tray and teaspoons on an under liner.
3. Refill coffee urns as needed. Use clear plastic pitchers or coffee pots to refill the urns front of house. Do not remove the urn and fill back of house.
4. Remove the lid from the coffee urn and place to the back of the table, out of the guests' way.
5. Pour the coffee into the urn using the side of the pitcher. Pouring the hot liquid from the front of the pitcher may cause spills.
6. Replenish half and half if creamer is less than half full. Replace the empty vessel with a full vessel. Do not bring the carton of half and half to the station to refill.
7. Clear dirty teaspoons and debris from garbage bowls to a linen-lined tray as needed. Do not allow garbage bowls to overflow.



TEAM WORK TIP → REGULAR ON THE RIGHT

Always set regular coffee on the right when building a coffee station. Make sure each urn has a menu card.



Building A Cold Beverage Station



Equipment Needed: Tables and Linen

- A. (1) 6 or 8 Foot Table
- B. (1) 6 or 8 Foot Bar Top
- C. (2) 6 or 8 Foot Linens

Equipment Needed: Product

- 1. Beverages as indicated on SEO
- 2. Clear beverage dispensers
- 3. European beverage glasses
- 4. Teaspoons
- 5. (1) Hammered metal ice tub
- 6. (1) Ice scoop
- 7. (2) Plastic pitchers
- 8. (1) Cocktail fork for lemon wedges
- 9. (1) White porcelain bowl for lemon wedges
- 10. (1) White porcelain square platter under liner for teaspoons
- 11. White porcelain bowls for station garbage
- 12. (1) Box white square beverage napkins
- 13. Décor as specified by your Event Supervisor

For disposable events, use clear plastic cups. Double the quantity of cups set on station. Substitute teaspoons for plastic stir sticks and display in disposable cup. Include (1) trash can with cover at station.

For beverage stations that also include soft drinks or bottled water, include (1) additional hammered metal tub to chill bottled water. Refer to SEO for specific accompaniments.



Station Set Up

1. Set base of the dispensers on either end of the bar top table. Set dispenser on top of base. Adjust dispenser so that the levers are set toward the guest.
2. Set evenly spaced rows of European beverage glasses in center of bar top table between both beverage dispensers.
3. Check to ensure that all glasses are clean and free of debris or water spots. Polish with warm water as needed.
4. Fill the (3) sugar caddies. Set all sugar packet labels with labels facing forward in the same direction.
5. Set empty hammered metal ice tub in center of base table. Set teaspoons on under liner.
7. Set white porcelain bowls or baskets for used or dirty teaspoons on either side of the hammered metal ice tub.
8. Set (2) cleanly stacked sets of white square beverage napkins on either side of table.
9. Fill beverage dispensers and ice approximately (30) minutes before service begins.

Stations & Buffets

Buffets can be arranged strategically to manage the flow of guests around a room and divided into themed tables to organize multiple styles. Event hosts warm up to this crowd-pleasing setup for its variety, flexibility, and efficiency. When faced with large groups or those with diverse tastes, buffets offer stress-free planning by allowing multiple entrée and accompaniment selections and give guests the freedom to fill their plates with only their favorite dishes.

Depending on the guest count, floor plan, and available space, buffets can be set up as a single-sided line, double-sided line, or even server or chef-attended to elevate the level of service. There are (3) types of station or buffets:

- Hors D'oeuvres
- Meal Time
- Dessert

Buffet Layouts

The structure and size of a buffet depends on the amount of space needed and the amount of space available. Because Puff 'n Stuff caters in a variety of different venues-from traditional event spaces to office buildings and in clients' homes, you must be able to take the basic foundation of buffet construction and apply these principles to your specific event!



PUFF 'N STUFF CATERING



Buffet Design and Décor

When building a station or buffet, design and décor must work together hand in hand. At Puff 'n Stuff Catering, we strive to plan and execute events where menu and service are paired together through a creative, cohesive look and style that is carried through every single detail. A successfully designed buffet or station will **wow** guests without them being able to explain why. They instinctively know something about what they've seen is special-maybe even extraordinary!

Food supplies the important visual design elements of color, texture, and shape. The station décor that is selected should compliment these elements with elevation, bright pops of greenery, and votive candles.



TEAM WORK TIP → VOTIVE CANDLES

Décor accents, especially votive candles, should always be grouped in trios or set on the station or buffet individually. Try alternating every group of (3) votives with (1) singular votive at different positions on the station to create eye-catching visual interest!

Buffet Set Up and Service

A well thought-out and executed plan is a distinct advantage in any successful buffet set up. Traffic flow and station layout are essential to the success of a buffet line.

Building A Buffet

Tables and Linens

- A. 6 or 8 Foot /Serpentine Tables
- B. 6 or 8 Foot Coordinating Linens

Station Equipment

- A. 3/7/8 Quart chafing dishes with Sterno fuel
- B. Plates
- C. Flatware
- D. Napkins
- E. Serving utensils
- F. (1) White porcelain platter under liners for each serving utensil
- G. (1) White porcelain platter under liners for each type of flatware
- H. (1) Lighter for Sterno
- I. (2) Pitchers
- J. Décor
- K. Votive candles



GLOSSARY TERM → CHAFER

A chafar (or chafing dish) is used to keep food at proper temperature during events. The main compartment sits on a stand with Sterno lit underneath. Inside the main compartment is a water pan filled with a shallow amount of water heated from beneath.



A B C D E F G H

Serving Utensils

- A. Short Tongs
- B/C. Long Tongs
- D. Slotted Spoon
- E. Spoon
- F. Ladle
- G. Spork
- H. Sprinkle Spoon

Station Set Up

1. Determine the direction in which guests will go through the buffet line.
2. Set plates in stacks of 20, 15, and 10. The shortest stack of plates should be closest to the guests' reach.
3. Remove any chipped, cracked, broken, mismatched, or by any means unsatisfactory plates from service immediately. Report it to your Event Supervisor who will record the issue.
4. Determine the order in which the menu items will be placed on the buffet. Buffets are set similarly to how a meal would progress-lightest foods set first to heaviest foods set last. For example: salad, bread, vegetable, starch, protein.
5. Set chafers on a single-sided buffet with handles facing toward the guest.
6. Set chafers on a double-sided buffet with handles accessible to guests on both sides of the buffet table.

Water In Chafers

⇒ Fill all chafers with approximately 1" of water in the water pan. Too much water will overflow once the food insert is placed in the chafers. Not enough water in the water pan will cause the pan to burn.

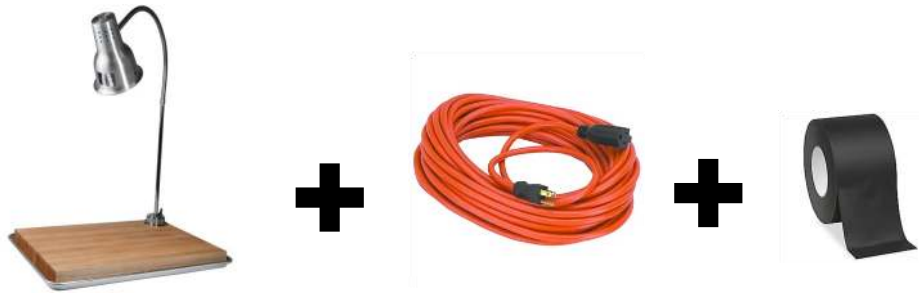
7. Remove Sterno fuel from inside chafers. Place underneath the chafers on stand.
8. Remove the cap from the Sterno and place directly underneath Sterno holder. You will need the Sterno cap to extinguish the Sterno fuel at the end of the event.



SAFETY TIP → LIFTING

When picking up or moving heavy equipment like chafers or plate crates, lift the equipment with your legs and not your back in order to avoid strain or injury to your body!

Heat Lamps



Should an item on your buffet require a heat lamp, follow the directions below for proper set up:

1. Set heat lamp in position on buffet. If an extension cord is needed, locate the closest power outlet to the buffet.
2. Plug one end of the extension cord into the heat lamp and the other end into the electrical outlet.
3. Tape down extension cord to prevent trip hazards for team members and guests.

Taping Extension Cords Down With Gaffers Tape

1. Select the most safe path for extension (along wall if possible). Tape beginning point down securely; then tape next point or end point while pulling cord taut.
2. Then go back and tape over the extension cord from beginning to end point. Repeat twice.



Station Replenish

1. Alert the culinary that you will need a new pan of an item when it reaches the half way mark. If the item must be cooked à la minute (like a pasta dish), provide the culinary with enough time to prepare a new pan.
2. Remove foil covering from chafer inserts and plastic wrap from platters and bowls back of house before transferring to the buffet or station. Remove any frill picks from dessert platters before transferring to the buffet or station.
3. Wipe edges of porcelain service ware from condensation if stored in refrigeration.
4. Always replenish plates or flatware to a buffet on a linen-lined tray. **Never carry plate crates or bus tubs through the floor during service!**
5. Use (2) clean, dry kitchen towels when removing pans from chafing dishes. This helps to prevent steam burns.
6. Remove the pans from the point farthest from the guest. This helps to prevent steam from rising into the guests' face.
7. Place the fresh pan into the chafing dish, with the point closest to the guest inserted first. This helps to avoid splashing of hot water onto the guest.
8. Never put the remains from the pan being replaced into the new pan. Take the leftovers to the kitchen or food prep area.
9. Never take the serving utensil out of a hot chafing dish and place it back on the under liner. The serving spoon or tong **MUST** remain in the pan once it is placed in. Replace the utensil if it has been removed from the pan.
10. Reset all item specific garnishes and sauces the same way. Reset all skewers facing the same direction.
11. Wipe down chafers, porcelain service ware, and serving utensils of any food debris or condensation throughout service.

Plated Meal Service

Plated service occurs on a pre-set timeline, which helps ensure that the event stays on schedule. Clients may choose to offer guests a single entrée (1 protein), dual entrée (2 proteins), or allow their guests to pre-select a meal from a choice of menu options. Pre-selected entrées may be indicated on a guest's place card by a stamp, symbol, or color. Some courses may be pre-set on the tables or all courses may be served to the table.

Your Event Supervisor will divide the reception space into sections of tables that you will be responsible for serving throughout the duration of the event. A diagram with the section assignments will be distributed or posted during the team pre-shift meeting. If you have any questions regarding your section, please see your Event Supervisor before the event begins. Before service begins, walk your section and double check that each table you are assigned to has all of the required items set for service.

Section Checklist

- ⇒ Is the linen properly placed on the table with vertical seams running from 12 to 6 o'clock in relationship to the guest entrance?
- ⇒ Is the chair count at each table correct according to the SEO and/or floor plan?
- ⇒ Is there a guide chair placed at the 12 o'clock position?
- ⇒ Are the remaining chairs in proper position, just touching the line, and evenly spaced around the table?
- ⇒ Are the place settings square with the chair and measure approximately 1 inch from the lip of the table?
- ⇒ Does each place setting have the required service ware and flatware needed for each course?
- ⇒ Does each place setting have a properly folded linen napkin?
- ⇒ Does each place setting have a pre-set water and the appropriate glassware needed for service (if any)?

If you answer **no** to any of the above questions, address the issue with your service partner(s) and your Event Supervisor, if needed, immediately.

**TEAM WORK TIP → WHEN THE GUEST STEPS AWAY**

Refold the guest's napkin when they step away from the table. Fold the napkin in a simple tri-fold to signal to the guest that we have taken notice and prepared for their return. Do not set the napkin over the back of the chair. The dirty napkin could stain or transfer debris onto the guest's jacket or back of their clothes. Reposition the chair and readjust the place setting before the guest returns.

Team Service

All plated functions will be served by the team system. This enables one server to primarily stay on the floor and one or two servers to pick up courses of food. As a team, Front and Back servers partner serve entire tables, one at a time, until entire section is served. The same process applies for clearing tables.

Front Servers/"A" Server

- Your role is to stay on the floor during service and assist with guest requests as needed.
- Never leave your section during meal service without communicating with your back server.

Back Servers/"B" Server

- Your role is to run food from the kitchen on trays to your Front/"A" server.
- Communicate all special meal requests to the kitchen and anticipate the next need of your Front Server.

As A Team

- Never leave a table partially served.
- No plates should be served to the table unless you have enough at your side stand to serve the complete table.

**EFFICIENCY TIP → LEAST INTRUSIVE**

Never cross in front of the guest in order to serve them. If guests are engaged in conversation and you are unable to serve or clear from the correct direction, complete service in whatever manner is the least intrusive to the guest(s).

Steps of Service

The steps of service for a plated meal will vary based on the number of courses, type of entree service (pre-selected, single, dual entree), and the client's timeline. Your Event Supervisor will communicate the expected steps of service and your individual section assignments during the pre-shift meeting so listen closely!

Sample Steps of Service: Salad, Entree, and Dessert

1. Event Supervisor signals for first course pick up.
2. Back server(s) return to the kitchen for salad course serve out.

3. Back server carries and sets tray on side stand. Do not begin to serve unless you have enough plates for each guest at the table.
4. Handle all dishes by the rim of the plate and keep your thumb tucked away and just underneath the rim.
5. Carry only (2) plates at one time from the tray to the table.
6. Use a service napkin to handle the plates if they are hot to the touch. Always caution guests that plates may be warm or hot to the touch as you place them. Use the phrase "Sir/Madam (Miss), May I?" An open hand beside the plate signals to the guest that you are requesting to clear it from their place setting.
7. Identify yourself to the guest if they are not aware of your presence. As you prepare to serve his or her plate, announce yourself to the guest and politely say "Pardon me Sir (or Miss)."
8. Front server places the salad plate in front of the guest from the left with your left hand. **Leave left.**
9. Clear the salad course plate, goosenecks with under liners and teaspoons, salad fork and salad knife from the guest's right side with the right hand. **Remove right.**
10. If wine was served, clear the first course wine from the guest's right side; leave on table if guest requests.
11. Wait for your Event Supervisor's signal to line up in the kitchen for entree course serve out.
12. Back server(s) return to the kitchen for entree course serve out.
13. Back server carries and sets tray on side stand. Do not begin to serve unless you have enough plates for each guest at the table.
14. Remove covers from (2) plates at a time at your side station.
15. Pick plates up from the tray and create a space on your tray or on the adjacent tray jack for plate covers to be set. **NEVER SET PLATE COVERS ON THE FLOOR DURING SERVICE!**
16. Identify yourself to the guest if they are not aware of your presence. As you prepare to serve his or her plate, announce yourself to the guest and politely say "Pardon me Sir (or Miss)."
17. Front server places the entree plate in front of the guest from the left with your left hand. **Leave left.**

18. Always set the plate with the protein at the 6 o'clock position in front of the guest, the vegetable at the 10 o'clock position, and the starch at 2 o'clock.
19. Clear only 2 plates at a time from the table and bus to side stand. Use the phrase "Sir/Madam (Miss), May I?" An open hand beside the plate signals to the guest that you are requesting to clear it from their place setting.
20. Clear the entree plate and dinner fork and dinner or steak knife from the guest's right side with the right hand. **Remove right.**
21. If wine was served, clear the entree course wine from the guest's right side; leave on table if guest requests.
22. Bus wine glasses to a separate bussing tray.
23. B&B plates and knives are cleared from the guest's left side as each guest's entrée plate is cleared.
24. Pick up bread baskets with tongs, butter with under liner plate, E.V.O.O. and balsamic plate, and salt and pepper from the table. All remaining items still on the guest tables from previous courses should be removed before dessert is served.
25. Wait for your Event Supervisor's signal to line up in the kitchen for dessert course serve out.
26. Back server(s) return to the kitchen for first course serve out.
27. Back server carries and sets tray on side stand. Do not begin to serve unless you have enough plates for each guest at the table.
28. Front server places the dessert in front of the guest from the left with your left hand..
29. Back server carries the coffee service trays and regular and decaf coffee pots to the side stand.
30. Place cream and sugar on the table to the right of the guest.
31. Set the coffee cup and saucer to the right side of the guest.
32. Offer the guest a choice of regular or decaf coffee and serve from the guest's right side.
33. Clear the dessert plate and dessert fork and teaspoon from the guest's right side with the right hand. **Remove right.** Use the phrase "Sir/Madam (Miss), May I?" An open hand beside the plate signals to the



GLOSSARY TERM → CHARGERS

A charger is a base plate that is set at the guest's place setting in addition to the flatware, glassware, and napkin. It is typically larger than a dinner plate and elevates the look and style of the table design. Chargers are usually cleared with the salad course, unless specified by your Event Supervisor. If an entrée is served on a 12" plate, the charger must be removed with the first course. It will not fit on top of the charger plate.

How To Serve A Table

1. Always serve ladies before gentlemen.
2. Always serve the oldest at the table before the youngest.
3. Walk Forward: After serving someone, walk forward in the direction you are facing. This is counter clockwise.
4. Walk clockwise while serving beverages and clearing.

How To Clear A Table

1. Clear only (2) plates at a time by hand to your side stand.
2. Clear all dirty dishes and glassware from the right with your right hand and move in a clock wise direction. Remove Right.
3. Place (2) plates side by side, then slide food debris onto one plate and stack the others. Do this with your back to the guests.
4. Stack scraped plates no more than 5 high and in no more than 2 stacks per tray.
5. Separate all dirty flatware by type. Place salad forks in a separate area on your tray from salad knives, and bread and butter knives in a different stack than steak knives.
6. Separate all glassware by type. Create even rows of like glassware to distribute weight evenly across the tray.
7. Clear all used paper goods (cocktail napkins, sugar packets, trash, etc) throughout service.
8. Clear any excess glassware (empty or watered down cocktail glasses, empty beer bottles, declined wine drinkers, champagne flutes after a toast, etc.) throughout service.
9. Remove glassware from the table by the stem or base of the glass. Never clear or carry glasses with your fingers inside the rim, clean or dirty.
10. Never clear plates or beverage glasses if you are unsure if a guest is finished with a particular item or drink. When in doubt, leave it out!
11. Do not clear the water glass unless it is clear the guest has left the event. Servers should continue to offer and replenish water for guests until conclusion of event.



SAFETY TIP → LIFTING

When picking up or moving heavy equipment like chafers or plate crates, lift the equipment with your legs and not your back in order to avoid strain or injury to your body!

How To Communicate With The Expo Chef

1. Approach the expo station with your linen napkin-lined football tray. As service continues, remember to bring your tray with you when you return to pick up entrees each time.
2. Communicate your entire order with only the expediting chef or the Event Supervisor. The expo chef will then communicate your order to the supporting chefs who are each responsible for pulling the entrees, adding a sauce or garnish to the plate, and/or wiping the rim of the plate and recapping them before stacking them on your tray.
3. For a single or dual entree: Request the number of regular entrees for your first table. Then request any special meals (vegan/vegetarian, gluten-free, kids meals).
4. For a pre-selected entree: Request the number of regular entrees for your first table. Example: 4 beef, 4 chicken. Then request any special meals (vegan/vegetarian, gluten-free, kids meals).

Kids Meals

Serve the entire children's meal with the first adult course (typically, this is a salad course), unless specified otherwise by your Event Supervisor.

Don't forget to pick up any dipping sauces for the kids meal entrees! Puff 'n Stuff offers both ketchup and honey mustard with our kids chicken tenders.

How To Handle Special Requests

Scenario: A guest asks you for a different entree other than what they had already pre-selected and is noted on their place card.

Solution:

1. Inform the guest that you will check with the chef or your Event Supervisor.
2. Alert your Lead Culinary and/or Event Supervisor and wait for approval before returning to the guest. The production kitchen sends a small amount of additional entrees as an overage but do not rely on this as a guarantee. You may be giving another guest's entree away!

3. If the Lead Culinary/Supervisor approves the switch, offer the guest their new selection!

Sample Response: *"I would be happy to check with the chef for you, but please enjoy the entree you've already selected while you wait. If an additional entree is available, I will bring it to you so you can try and enjoy that as well!"*

Scenario: A guest asks you for a vegetarian or vegan entree that was not pre-ordered. No vegetarian or vegan option is available as an entree choice.

Solution :

1. Inform the guest that you will check with the chef or your Event Supervisor.
2. Alert your Lead Culinary and/or Event Supervisor. The production kitchen sends a small amount of additional salad greens, salad ingredients as well as extra vegetable and starch portions as an overage just in case. Ask the lead what can be made to accommodate the guest's dietary needs. Chefs are creative by nature and can usually make a suitable alternative meal for that guest!
3. If the Lead Culinary/Supervisor can create the entree, offer the guest their new entree selection! Inform the guest of the wait time if the new entree must be created from scratch and even offer a beverage from the bar while he/she waits for the meal to be prepared!



TEAM WORK TIP → NO GUEST LEFT UNSERVED

ALWAYS serve complete tables! Never leave a table partially served. If you or your back server(s) cannot carry enough plates to serve the entire table in (1) trip, the back server(s) must return to the expo station to pick up the remaining plates before you begin to serve the table.